



First Unitarian Universalist Church of San Diego

UU Men's *Fellowship*

Handbook

Order of Service · Norms & Traditions
Chants · Songs & Hymns · Poems & Readings

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*This is the practical member's handbook — the script and reference for running a gathering.
For the full guide to the fellowship (mission, meetings, renewals, history), see the companion
Member Guide & Handbook booklet.*

WHO WE ARE

About the

Men deepening who we are — as brothers, sons, fathers, grandfathers, husbands, and partners.

Our Mission

Our mission is to support men in the quest for lives of compassion, integrity, responsibility, and balance.

Through mutually supportive work, our fellowship seeks to help men in their development as sons... Fathers... Brothers... Companions and members of society.

We are a caring, intentionally diverse brotherhood, committed to social justice and offering opportunities for intimate sharing, personal growth, and spiritual deepening.

You don't need to be a member of First UU San Diego, and you don't need to identify with any religion. You just need to be a man who wants deeper community.

MISSION — CORE VALUES

Our *Values*

01 **Compassion**

For ourselves and those around us — without condition or reserve.

02 **Integrity**

Showing up honestly in all our relationships, especially the hard ones.

03 **Responsibility**

To our families, our communities, and the wider world we share.

04 **Balance**

Nurturing our whole selves — mind, body, and spirit.

WHO TO REACH

Leadership & *Contacts*

The UUMF is guided by a Steering Committee operating on a consensus model. All members are welcome to participate in governance.

Co-Convener

Jim Hurtado

Monthly meetings & general info

Co-Convener

Chris Guelich

Steering Committee & direction

Renewals Contact

Mike Dorfi

Fall & Spring renewal weekends

Focus Group Coordinator

[Name]

Focus group placement & formation

EACH FOURTH MONDAY

Order of

Our evening follows a consistent rhythm — familiar enough to feel like home, open enough to hold whatever arises.

6— Potluck Dinner

7 Arrive, share food, and connect informally. First-timers never need to bring a dish — just come as you are.

7pm Welcome Circle Opens

We come together as a group and open the circle with four elements. The facilitator (or any member) can read the passages below aloud.

1. Mission Statement

Facilitator reads aloud:

"Our mission is to support men in the quest for lives of compassion, integrity, responsibility, and balance. We are a caring, intentionally diverse brotherhood, committed to social justice, and offering opportunities for intimate sharing, personal growth, and spiritual deepening. Our goal as a fellowship is that after each gathering, we can say to ourselves that we know a little more about ourselves as men, sons, and brothers."

2. Lighting of the Chalice

A chalice is lit to mark the opening of our shared space. Suggested words (customize as you like):

"We light this chalice to mark the beginning of our time together — a symbol of the light we bring to one another, and the truth we seek in community."

3. Gong of the Bowl

Ring the bowl once. Allow the sound to fade into silence — a slow count of ten — before speaking again. A moment of collective stillness; we arrive together before we begin.

4. Confidentiality Statement

Facilitator reads aloud:

"The fellowship is built upon trust that what is shared in ALL the circles is to be held in the strictest of confidence!"

7— Circle Check-In

8

Each man takes a turn to share how he's doing — what's alive for him, what he's carrying or celebrating. No cross-talk. No advice. Just being heard.

8— **Small Groups**

9 We break into smaller circles to go deeper — sharing responses to questions or themes, supporting one another. After small group time, we return as a full circle.

9pm **Closing Circle**

We close with a poem, song, or chant together — then clean up, stack chairs, and put the space back as we found it.

Norms &

Our official Gathering Guidelines, verbatim — plus two long-standing practices that round out how we hold the space together.

01 Confidentiality

The fellowship is built upon trust that what is shared in ALL the circles is to be held in the strictest of confidence!

02 The Right to Reticence

Share only as deep as you are comfortable.

03 Use "I" Statements

Tell YOUR story and how YOU feel.

04 Active Listening

No cross talk.

05 Give No Advice

Unless requested, and usually after the gathering.

06 Speak Loudly

So that all can hear and understand your story.

07 Allow Time for Everyone to Share

Before you share a second time.

08 Chants Are Sung Together

Chants are sung three times — the first time robust, the second louder, the third quieter or hummed. The leader often steps up volume on key phrases. Tune out your inner critic and just sing.

09 **The Potluck Is Part of the Gathering**

Breaking bread together is the first act of fellowship. Come early enough to share the meal. First-timers are never expected to bring food.

The

Chants are sung three times — robust, louder, then quieter or hummed. The leader often steps up volume on key phrases.

Chant 01

When I Breathe In

When I breathe in, I breathe in peace
When I breathe out, I breathe out love

Chant 02

Comfort Me

Comfort me, comfort me, comfort me
oh my soul
(sing, dance, speak for, etc.)

Chant 03

Journey Together

We are going, on a journey together
Takin' it easy, takin' it slow
Now more hurry, no more worry
Nothin' to carry, let it all go

The words "slow" and "go" are sung more slowly and in the deeper range of your voice. The rest should be robust with good cadence. The leader often steps up the volume on "we are going."

Chant 04

Listen to My Heart Song

Listen, listen, listen to my heart song
(repeat)
I will never forget you, I will never forsake you (repeat)

Chant 05

I Am a Circle

I am a circle... I am healing you
You are a circle... you are healing me
Unite us, make us one... Unite us, make us one

last verse: "we ARE one"

The word "unite" slides into a three-syllable pronunciation: you-ewe-nite

Chant 06

Grandfather

I Grandfather, grandfather, we are calling (repeat)
Come, come, come
II We are calling all our brothers (repeat)
Who have gone before
III We are calling all our fathers (repeat)
Who have gone before

Chant 07

All This Joy

All this joy, all this sorrow, all this
promise, all this change
Such is life, such is being, such is spirit,
such is love

Chant 08

Earth My Body

Earth my Body, Water my Blood
Air my Breath and FIRE my spirit

Chant 09

Spiraling

Spiraling into the center, the center of
the wheel (repeat)
I am the weaver, I am the woven one
I am the dreamer, I am the dream

Chant 10

Return Again

Return again, return again
Return to the home of your soul (repeat)
Return to who you are, return to what
you are
Return to where you are
Born and reborn again (repeat)

Chant 11

Go in Peace

Go in peace, go in kindness, go in joy,
go in love
Leave the day, the day behind us, day is
done, go in grace
Let us go into the dark, not afraid, not
alone
Let us hope by some good pleasure,
safely to arrive at home
(repeat last line)

Chant 12

Draw the Circle Wide

Draw the circle, draw the circle wide
Draw the circle, draw the circle wide
No one stands alone, we'll stand side by
side
Draw the circle, draw the circle wide
(repeat)

Draw the circle wide, draw it wider still
Let this be our song — no one stands
alone
Standing side by side
Draw the circle, draw the circle wide
(repeat)

Draw the circle, draw the circle wide.

Chant 13

Pura Sa May

Pura sa may, Pura sa may, pura sa may-
o, pura sa may
Pura ma may, pura ma may, pura ma
may-o, pura ma may

Chant 14

Om Na Ma Shive

Om na ma shive (repeat 3 times)
Shiva om na ma

Chant 15

Man in Me

There's a man in me, there's a man in
you

There's a woman in me, there's a woman
in you

There's a child in me... there's a child in
you

There's a god(ess) in me, there's a
god(ess) in you

AND the man in me loves the man in
you

And woman in me...

And the god(ess) in me IS the god(ess)
in you

Music of the

Hymn #1064

Blue Boat Home

Words: Peter Mayer · Music: Rowland H. Prichard

Though below me, I feel no motion
standing on these mountains and plains
Far away from the rolling ocean
still my dry land heart can say:

I've been sailing all my life now,
never harbor or port have I known
The wide universe is the ocean I travel
and the earth is my blue boat home

Sun my sail and moon my rudder
as I ply the starry sea,
leaning over the edge in wonder,
casting questions into the deep

Drifting here with my ship's companions,
all we kindred pilgrim souls,
making our way by the lights of the heavens
in our beautiful blue boat home

I give thanks to the waves upholding me,
hail the great winds urging me on,
greet the infinite sea before me,
sing the sky my sailor's song:

I was born up on the fathoms,
never harbor or port have I known
The wide universe is the ocean I travel,
and the earth is my blue boat home

How Sweet the Darkness

Words: Rachel Bates · Music: Jason Shelton, © 2002

Verse 1:

When windows that are black and cold
are lit anew with fires of gold;
When dusk in quiet shall descend
and darkness come once more a friend.

Verse 2:

When wings pursue their proper flight
and bring not terror but delight;
When clouds are innocent again
and hide no storms of deadly rain;

Verse 3:

And when the sky is swept of wars
and keeps but gentle moon and stars,
that peaceful sky, that harmless air,
how sweet, how sweet the darkness there.

O Brother Sun

Adapted from St. Francis of Assisi by Sharon Anway, © 2004 · Music: Traditional Scottish

Verse 1:

O Brother Sun, you bring us light,
all shining 'round in fiery might.
O Sister Moon, you heal and bless,
your beauty shines in tenderness.

Verse 2:

O Brother Fire, you warm our night
with all your dancing colored light.
O Sister Earth, you feed all things,
all birds, all creatures, all scales and wings.

O Brother Wind, you sweep the hills,
your mighty breath both freshens and fills.
O Sister Water, you cleanse and flow
through rivers and streams, in ice and snow.

O Sister Death, you meet us here
and take us to our God so near.
O God of Life, we give you praise
for all your creatures, for all your ways.

First UU Church Hymn

From All Who Dwell Below the Skies

Bilingual: English & Spanish

From all who dwell below the skies,
Let faith and hope with love arise,
Let beauty, truth, and good be sung
Through every land, by every tongue

En Español:

De todos bajo el gran sol
Surja esperanza, fe, amor
Verdad y belleza cantando,
De cada tierra, cada voz

You Are Welcome Here

Words: Marty Parks · Used at First UU San Diego services

Come, you wounded, weakened, and weary, you are welcome here.

Come, discouraged, come, brokenhearted, you are welcome here.

This is a refuge for grace; this is a harbor of mercy.

So come, you wounded, weakened, and weary, you are welcome here, you are welcome here.

Come, you wanderer, spent from the journey. Come with every burden you carry, you are welcome here.

This is a refuge for grace; this is a harbor for mercy.

So come you wanderer, spent from the journey, you are welcome here, you are welcome here.

Come, enter love's embrace; receive amazing grace here in this place.

Come, you hungry; come, all you thirsty, you are welcome here.

Come for healing, strength, and forgiveness, you are welcome here. You are welcome here.

Stand By Me

Ben E. King · Brotherhood version used at closings

When the night has come
And the land is dark
And the moon is the only light we'll see
No, I won't be afraid
No, I won't be afraid
Just as long as you stand, stand by me

So Brother, Brother, stand by me
Oh, stand by me
... Oh, stand
Stand by me (stand by me)

If the sky that we look upon
Should tumble and fall
Or the mountains should crumble to the sea
I won't cry, I won't cry
No, I won't shed a tear
Just as long as you stand, Stand by me

Whenever you're in trouble,
Won't you stand by me
Oh, stand by me
Oh, just stand now
Oh, stand, stand by me

Classic

Daydream

The Lovin' Spoonful · Used at lighter gatherings

What a day for a daydream

What a day for a daydreamin' boy

And now I'm lost in a daydream

Dreamin' 'bout my bundle of joy

I've been havin' a sweet dream

I've been dreamin' since I woke up today

It's starrin' me and my sweet thing

'Cause he's the one makes me feel this way

And you can be sure that if you're feelin' allright

A daydream will last 'til long into the night

Tomorrow at breakfast, you may prick up your ears

Or you may be dreamin' for a thousand years

What a day for a daydream

Custom-made for a daydreamin' boy

Now I'm lost in a daydream

Dreamin' 'bout my bundle of joy

UUMF Chant Song

Unitarian Universalism

Presented by Laila Ibrahim · de Benneville Summer Break Workshop

It's a blessing each of us was born

It matters what we do with our lives

What each of us knows about God is a piece of the truth

We don't have to do it alone

Unitarian Universalism

Not yet an official UUMF chant — introduced at a de Benneville Summer Break workshop.

Mae-e ("Forward")

Words: Kentaro Sato · English translation used at First UU San Diego services

I remember your warm hand. I remember your kind voice. I remember your honest eyes & quiet prayer.

When I close my eyes I recall the time we spent together & the time we sang together. The end of music . . . is not our farewell.

As music lives again, so will you live again & again in my memory.

Ah! I remember . . . A dream you cherished. I remember . . . A smile you beamed at tomorrow. With memories of you in my heart, one step at a time, I walk forward. Embracing every day's happiness . . . & sadness . . .

One step at a time, One step at a time, I walk forward, I walk forward.

WORDS THAT HOLD US

Poems & *Readings*

Dark of Winter

Words by Shelly Jackson Denham · Used at winter gatherings & renewal weekends

Dark of winter, soft and still,
Your quiet calm surrounds me.
Let my thoughts go where they will,
Ease my mind profoundly
And then my soul will sing a song,
A blessed song of love eternal.
Gentle darkness soft and still
Bring your quiet to me.

Darkness, soothe my weary eyes,
That I may see more clearly.
When my heart with sorrow cries,
Comfort and caress me.
And then my soul may hear a voice,
A still small voice of love eternal.
Darkness, when my fears arise,
Let your peace flow through me.

TRANSCENDING MYSTERY AND WONDER

The Celebration of Life

525 · Web

Denise Levertov

Intricate and untraceable weaving and interweaving, dark strand with light:
Designed, beyond
All spiderly contrivance, To link, not to entrap:
Elation, grief, joy, contrition, entwined;
shaking, changing, forever forming, transforming:
All praise, all praise to the great web.

526 · Trembling with Joy

Inuit Shaman Uvavnuuk

The great sea has set me in motion,
set me adrift,
moving me like a weed in a river.
The sky and the strong wind have moved the spirit inside me
till I am carried away
trembling with joy.

527 · Immortality

Richard Jefferies

It is eternity now.
I am in the midst of it.
It is about me, in the sunshine;
I am in it, as the butterfly in the light-laden air.
Nothing has to come,
It is now.
Now is eternity,
Now is the immortal life.

528 · I've Known Rivers

Langston Hughes

I've known rivers:
I've known rivers ancient as the world and older than the flow of human blood in human veins.
My soul has grown deep like the rivers.

I bathed in the Euphrates when dawns were young.
I built my hut near the Congo and it lulled me to sleep.
I looked upon the Nile and raised the pyramids above it.
I heard the singing of the Mississippi when Abe Lincoln went down to New Orleans,
and I've seen its muddy bosom turn all golden in the sunset.

I've known rivers:
Ancient, dusky rivers.

My soul has grown deep like the rivers.

529 · The Stream of Life

Rabindranath Tagore

The same stream of life that runs through my veins night and day runs through the world
and dances in rhythmic measures.

It is the same life that shoots in joy through the dust of the earth in numberless blades of
grass and breaks into tumultuous waves of leaves and flowers.

It is the same life that is rocked in the ocean-cradle of birth and death, in ebb and in flow.

I feel my limbs are made glorious by the touch of this world of life.

And my pride is from the life-throb of ages dancing in my blood this moment.

530 · Out of the Stars

Robert T. Weston

Out of the stars in their flight, out of the dust of eternity, here have we come,

Stardust and sunlight, mingling through time and through space.

Out of the stars have we come, up from time;

Out of the stars have we come.

Time out of time before time in the vastness of space, earth spun to orbit the sun,

Earth with the thunder of mountains newborn, the boiling of seas.

Earth warmed by sun, lit by sunlight:

This is our home;

Out of the stars have we come.

Mystery hidden in mystery, back through all time;

Mystery rising from rocks in the storm and the sea.

Out of the stars, rising from rocks and the sea, kindled by sunlight on earth, arose life.

Ponder this thing in your heart; ponder with awe:

Out of the sea to the land, out of the shallows came ferns.

Out of the sea to the land, up from darkness to light,

Rising to walk and to fly, out of the sea trembled life.

Ponder this thing in your heart, life up from sea:

Eyes to behold, throats to sing, mates to love.

Life from the sea, warmed by sun, washed by rain, life from within, giving birth, rose to
love.

This is the wonder of time, this is the marvel of space;

Out of the stars swung the earth; life upon earth rose to love.

This is the marvel of life, rising to see and to know;

Out of your heart, cry wonder: sing that we live.

WHERE WE CAME FROM

Our

The story of how a community of men came together — and why it has endured.

Roots

Our Home: First UU San Diego

The UUMF meets at **First Unitarian Universalist Church of San Diego** — one of the oldest congregations in the city. Unitarians first gathered here in 1873, when a small Sunday School met at Horton Hall on June 22 of that year. By 1877, the group had grown and formally organized as *The Unitarian Society of San Diego*.

The Hillcrest Campus — where the UUMF holds its Fourth Monday gatherings in the Common Room — was built in 1959. The church has been a center for liberal religion, free thought, and social justice in San Diego for over 150 years.

One of the church's founding members, **Alonzo Erasmus Horton** — the developer whose name still marks a neighborhood downtown — was among San Diego's early Unitarians seeking to establish a center for religious education and free thought.

Camp de Benneville Pines

The UUMF's Spring Renewal takes place at **Camp de Benneville Pines**, a UU camp in the San Bernardino National Forest above Angelus Oaks — at 6,800 feet elevation, surrounded by pine, cedar, and oak. The camp was founded in 1961, purchased by UU congregations from San Diego to Santa Monica to Arizona pooling their resources together.

It remains one of the few UU-affiliated camps in the country and serves over 60 groups a year. For UUMF, it has been the setting for some of the most significant weekends in men's lives — the kind of experience that men return to year after year.

Broader Movement

The Southern California UU Men's Network

UUMF is one of several UU men's fellowships in Southern California. The Fall Renewal near Julian brings these groups together for a multi-congregation gathering — men from San Diego to other UU churches across the region spending three days in the mountains together.

THE THREAD

What Has *Endured*

Whatever year the fellowship began, and whatever the specific story of its founding, certain things have remained constant: a circle of men showing up for each other, month after month. A table with food on it. A check-in round where every voice is heard. Chants sung together. The mountains, twice a year.

The history is not only in the past. Every man who walks through the door for the first time is adding to it. Every Fourth Monday, every renewal, every focus group conversation — the story keeps going.

STAY CONNECTED

Links &

Where to find us online, and where this handbook's content lives.

Our Church

First Unitarian Universalist Church of San Diego

<https://www.firstuusandiego.org>

UUMF Website

UU Men's Fellowship

<https://anotterbryan.github.io/uumf/>

Source Code

UUMF on GitHub

<https://github.com/anotterbryan/uumf>

